

Funded ratio	Are there sufficient assets to meet retirement goals without taking market risk? Is there excess discretionary wealth, or are you underfunded with respect to goals?
Availability of reserves and exposures to spending shocks	How much exposure is there to large and uncertain expenses? What insurance policies or other reserves are available to manage these shocks? Are there buffer assets? How is home equity used within the plan?
Aspirations (Goals)	
Lifestyle	What is the retirement budget? How does it change over time? How closely connected is it to consumer price inflation?
Legacy	What are the legacy goals? How important is legacy relative to other goals?
Returns (Assumptions)	
Capital market expectations	What are reasonable market return assumptions for different asset classes and inflation to guide simulation of the retirement income plan? How are returns impacted by investor behavior, fees, taxes, and investment vehicle choices?
Emotional Comfort (Constraints)	
Traditional risk aversion	How much short-term portfolio volatility can you stomach before it affects your sleep and leads you